

the image. For example, you may want to show a picture of a group of people without individual faces being discernable. Here, you can use the Diffuse or Blur or other filters to blur out specific details while retaining the overall shapes in the image to denote a group of people.

Let us look at the two correcting filters we mentioned above—Blur and Sharpen. Their uses are quite apparent from their names. Let's say you've shot a picture in low light, and the resulting image appears with dots all over. One way you can reduce this effect is by applying the Blur filter. While the Blur filter will reduce pixelation, it will also make parts (or even all) of the image look smudged—it is up to you to strike a balance between removing the unwanted dots and introducing the smudge effect.

The Sharpen filter is used for the opposite purpose. If your camera shook while you clicked your shot, the resulting image will look blurred. Or, let's say you want your image to have precise and well-defined edges. These are cases where you can use the Sharpen tool. This filter literally *sharpens* the image—it looks more well-defined, and the effect is something like the opposite of blurring. The downside is that if your image was originally low in quality, pixelation will occur.

You can experiment with other filters that will change your image in some particular way. Many of the filters require you to enter number values to determine by what extent the image will be changed. Just changing these values will sometimes produce variations that will surprise you! Further, you can use two or more filters, or apply these filters in a different order. So let the creativity out!